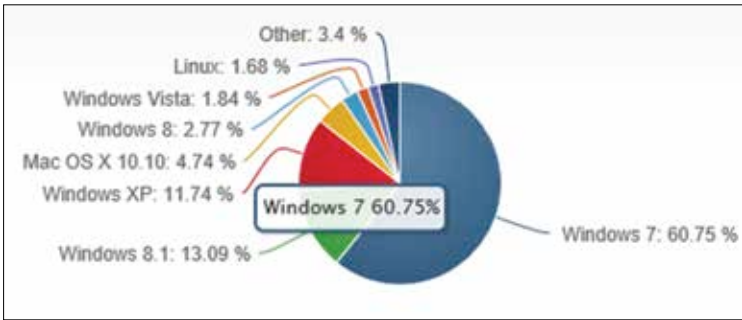




Operating systems market share

get Windows for free and don't give Microsoft any money, nothing new there, so we'll leave them out.

Now, Microsoft hasn't made Windows 10 entirely free. If you buy a new computer with Windows 10 on it, or you are building a new computer and you want to get a copy of Windows 10, you still pay for it. Microsoft is still making money from new customers and new devices, and new licenses. No loss for Microsoft there.

Then there are those running older versions of Windows. Amongst this group, not all would have been interested in purchasing an upgrade. After all there are still many people running Windows 7, XP and Vista (yes there are some people still using Vista). These people weren't going to give Microsoft any more money anyway so what does Microsoft lose by giving them Windows 10? Just a little bandwidth, which those users use up any way with Windows updates. Finally we have those who are running older versions of Windows, and who would be the kind to fork out money for an upgrade.

This is not a very large audience to begin with. After all Windows 7 kept gaining a share despite the release of Windows 8 and 8.1, meaning that a majority of the growth of Windows 8.x came at the expense of XP, from new purchases.

By giving away Windows 10 for free Microsoft is sacrificing the money it would get from those who would pay for upgrades, but in return they are converting Windows 7, 8 and 8.1 users into the unified base of Windows 10.

Their best case scenario is that all users running Windows 7, 8, and 8.1 move to Windows 10. Those running XP and Vista probably don't have computers capable of running newer OSes or they just want to stick with what they know. Besides, if those users really want to upgrade, they still